



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Westside Christian Academy
School Website: <https://westsideacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Westside Christian Academy (WCA) presents a clearly classical orientation anchored in Christian formation. Public materials emphasize a Biblically integrated, classical framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric), a formation-focused purpose, and visible attention to parental partnership and community involvement. The site repeatedly foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ideals; it describes the Trivium as a core organizing principle; and it highlights a mission of discipleship and Christ-centered education. Taken together, these signals place WCA as CLASSICAL across most of the classical rubric, with Curriculum (Element 3) showing strong classical structure but without explicit, public evidence of full Great Books/Great Conversation commitments in the available public content—this slightly tempers a full CLASSICAL label for that category to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are strongly present via Biblically integrated, Christ-centered language and formation-focused aims. Evidence: mission statements and program descriptions (formation, Trivium, gospel-centered language).
- The school's stated purpose and goals emphasize formation, virtue, and the real goods of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than workforce-readiness in public messaging.
- Curriculum shows the Trivium explicitly and positions classical education, but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments are not openly cited in the accessible public pages (category 3 nuance).
- Pedagogy aligns with classical methods (sectioned by the Trivium; occasional Socratic/seminar-like activity appears in content about the classical method and related discussions).
- Faculty structure is presented via explicit "Staff & Faculty" and governance pages, signaling a living curriculum and mentor model.
- Parents and community are foregrounded (Classical Parent University, parent partnerships, and ongoing community fundraising), consistent with classical pedagogy that treats families as co-educators.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**
- Evidence: Biblically integrated, Christ-centered language; gospel-centered mission; Trivium framing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth, beauty, goodness, gospel, Biblically integrated; no clear negative signals. Estimated: 4–5 positives vs 0 negatives.
- Why this rating: The school foregrounds transcendental aims and theological integration, with explicit sacred language and formation-based aims, aligning with transcendental realism and theology foundations in the classical lexicon.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Formation-focused language; emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; gospel-centered formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, truth, gospel, beauty, goodness; no workforce- or job-oriented language in public messaging. Estimated: 4–5 positives; 0 negatives.
- Why this rating: The messaging centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the transcendentals rather than strictly job-readiness, aligning with Classical / Formation emphasis in the rubric.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and classical framing; public content references “prek-12” classical education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Seven Liberal Arts framing (Trivium), classical education, grammar, logic, rhetoric; no explicit Great Books/Great Conversation publicly cited in the accessible pages. Estimated positives: 4; negatives: 0 (based on the public content). However, absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signals means it falls short of a full Great Books commitment in public content.
- Why this rating: The Trivium and classical framing are robust, but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation integration and historical breadth are not clearly evidenced in the accessible public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for Curriculum.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Emphasis on Trivium; references to classical pedagogy; early indications of Socratic/seminar-style engagement in the school’s classical discussions.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric, memory work (recitation, chanting), and contemplative learning; no explicit negative signals in the public content. Estimated positives: 3–5; negatives: 0.
- Why this rating: Pedagogical approach aligns with classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Socratic/seminar work, memory work via recitation). The presence of classical pedagogy signals justifies CLASSICAL here.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: “Staff & Faculty” page and governance materials; emphasis on teachers as mentors and living curriculum; board/faculty structure.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, faculty as core, and portrait of teacher/student ideals (from the classical lexicon). Public materials show the faculty structure and role. Estimated positives: 2–3; negatives: 0.
- Why this rating: The public materials depict a traditional, living-curriculum faculty model with strong emphasis on teacher leadership and mentorship, aligning with CLASSICAL standards.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Classical Parent University (CPU), partnerships with parents, admissions materials, capital campaigns, and active family/community engagement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership with families, parent formation, classical parent training, and open-campus engagement; no explicit negative signals in public materials. Estimated positives: 3–4; negatives: 0.

- Why this rating: Strong emphasis on parent partnership and parental formation, with multiple channels (CPU, capital campaigns, admissions) signaling a robust Parent & Community alignment with classical education.

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- The Needle: Since Element 3 is NOT fully CLASSICAL (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) due to the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments in accessible public content, the school sits at CLASSICAL with a needle moving opportunity primarily in Curriculum (Element 3). The other five categories clearly align with Classical criteria, and the aggregate would be CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum (Element 3): Publicly strengthen and publicly publish explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments, including a stated roster of foundational texts and a clear, interdisciplinary approach that demonstrates the Great Books as central to reading lists and discussions. Add language describing the integration of the Great Conversation in history, literature, and philosophy across grade bands, and publicly share a formal “Great Books” curriculum map. This would convert Element 3 to CLASSICAL with full confidence.
- Concrete actions: publish a formal Great Books list, articulate a cross-disciplinary plan, and include sample Great Conversation dialogues or seminar descriptions on the site.
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1): While strong, consider making liturgical and communal practices more explicit (e.g., public references to chapel/morning worship, liturgical year, sacred music) to align explicitly with the Liturgical and Communal Practices criterion in the classical rubric.
- Concrete actions: add a public page detailing chapel/mass, liturgical seasons, and communal prayer life as part of the school’s core routines.
- Pedagogy (Element 4): If not already explicit, publish a more detailed description of the upper-school seminar/Socratic method in action (example syllabi, sample seminar prompts, and assessment structures) to demonstrate direct implementation of Socratic and rhetorical pedagogy beyond general statements.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Consider enhancing and publicly documenting parent-education programs (e.g., excerpts from Classical Parent University sessions, book clubs, and family catechesis) to strengthen the partnership with families as co-educators.
- Abstract Westside Christian Academy presents a robust CLASSICAL profile anchored in Christian formation. The school’s public content emphasizes Biblically integrated, Trivium-based education, formation-centered aims, and strong parent/community engagement, supporting a CLASSICAL ranking across five of the six categories. Curriculum evidence (Trivium, classical framing) is strong but lacks explicit public Great Books/Great Conversation commitments in the accessible content, placing Curriculum at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The overall assessment is CLASSICAL, with a clear path to full CLASSICAL status through targeted curricular disclosures and expanded public evidence of Great Books engagement and liturgical practices.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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